

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 347

By Roberts

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend Chief Joe Williams of the White House Community Volunteer Fire Department.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, Chief Joe Williams is one such estimable individual, who has served with distinction for forty-six years as a member of the White House Community Volunteer Fire Department; and

WHEREAS, early observances of local fires, including a home on his parents' farm catching fire when he was in kindergarten, influenced Chief Williams's decision to devote his life as a firefighter; and

WHEREAS, as a boy, he witnessed a neighborhood fire, watched the fire trucks pull in, and ran over to the scene, where firemen let him help pull the hose; after that, when he heard fire trucks coming, he waited at the end of his driveway, and the firefighters stopped and picked him up to go along; and

WHEREAS, when he was eleven years old, he lost his father; it was then that local firefighters were instrumental in stepping up to serve as father figures in his life; and

WHEREAS, Chief Williams officially began his service to the citizens of White House in 1979, at the age of only sixteen; at that time, he was also working with the local volunteer ambulance service; and

WHEREAS, during his distinguished tenure, Chief Williams has served in his roles as Assistant Chief and now Chief with a great deal of pride, always doing his utmost to bring honor, integrity, and compassionate service to his office; and

WHEREAS, Chief Joe Williams has inspired his sons to devote their efforts to firefighting, as well; one of his sons works behind the scenes with statistics and information, and the other has made firefighting a lifetime career; and

WHEREAS, firefighting has been a way of life for Joe Williams, and he has wholly devoted himself to serving his community for more than four decades, earning the admiration and respect of his colleagues and a grateful public; and

WHEREAS, Chief Williams exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, Chief Joe Williams has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity while serving and protecting the residents of White House; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend Chief Joe Williams of the White House Community Volunteer Fire Department, extending our gratitude for his many years of devoted service.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.